

Droidgasm!

Like it or not, Android has pretty much taken the handset world by storm and there are a legion of determined droids around vying for your hard earned dough. Here's what you should buy, and why...



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If you're any kind of gadget freak, you'll know that Donut, Éclair and Gingerbread do not have much in common with tasty treats of similar name. But wait – they do! After all we're consuming devices that feature these versions of Android faster than their namesakes. According to a report published by Canalys, a technology-centric analysis agency, in Q4 2010, Android was the world's best-selling smartphone platform, dethroning Symbian from its 10-year reign. This from a platform that was essentially unveiled by Google in late 2007 is a laudable attempt to say the least. Since then, Android has grown by leaps and bounds, and it is one of the forerunners in pushing hardware demands of smartphones outwards.

Given the popularity of Android, the hype surrounding it (a lot of which is deserved), the sheer options in terms of devices available as well as the number of our beloved readers who enquire about devices on this platform, we felt it only fair to have a comparison shootout between some of the newest,

and best Android devices available in the market today.

Phones up to ₹10,000: mini-droids

All things considered the three phones featured in this category are all pretty decent options. However, keep the following points in mind. Firstly, such phones will have lesser spec'd hardware in comparison to the premium phones, and your experience will thus suffer. We aren't just referring to the processor, RAM and graphics solution, but also the display quality and the feel and responsiveness of the capacitive display. This isn't meant as a scare, but value for money is not to be mistaken for a great product. Therefore, while a phone might be half the price of another, even a 10 per cent drop in performance might be very noticeable and ruin the experience to the extent that the user regrets not paying for the better option.

No phone here was capable of displaying 16 million colours. Also, you do not get a display larger than 3.2-inches. While this might feel great if you're migrating

from a regular 2-inch display, when it comes to touchscreens something less than 3.2-inch may feel cramped, however this is subjective.

Features, build and usability:

The Micromax A60 is unusual looking, with a broad upper portion that tapers to a narrow bottom. The rear of the phone is also contoured, and the matt-black, rubberised body of the A60 grips securely. Although the build quality of the battery leaves something to be desired, unlike the Videocon Zeus that feels a lot better built and solid. The Huawei Ideos U8150 feels even more rugged. Both the Zeus and the U8150 do not feel built to a price, at least until you switch them on.

Looks aside, there is very little to pick

between these phones, and in terms of features they are neck and neck. The Zeus does make a better impression in terms of features and its appearance owing to a marginally higher resolution display as well as a higher resolution camera.

Performance:

The lack of onscreen resolution and colour becomes apparent as soon as these phones are switched on. There is not a lot that differentiates these three phones when it comes to call clarity, although the Huawei U8150's performance was marginally lower. The Micromax A60 misses a trick with mediocre earpiece volume, where we constantly had to ask the person on the other side to repeat their sentences. All three cameras are fairly mediocre, with not much to choose between them in terms of resolution and detail, and while the Zeus has a higher resolution five-megapixel camera, it doesn't offer any tangible advantages over the 3.2-megapixel units on the other two. Although the Zeus has a higher resolution display, it doesn't do much to distance itself from the Huawei Ideos U8150, which offers better colour.

BEST BUY
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Micromax A60